

Faysal Ahmed

VP of SEO & Organic Growth

contactfaysal@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/faysalahmed | (647) 234-8739 | Mississauga, Ontario, Canada

Digital marketing and SEO professional with 22 years of experience driving organic growth at scale. Career spans independent consulting, agency work at Cardinal Path and Merkle Cardinal Path, regulated-industry marketing at Klick Health, and in-house Director-level leadership at Canada's largest automotive marketplace, AutoTrader.ca.

Distinctive combination of deep technical SEO expertise, marketing analytics fluency, and hands-on product management for engineering teams. Currently targeting VP of SEO, PM/SEO Growth, Director of Digital Marketing, or Director of Marketing Analytics roles — open to in-house and agency, with a preference for SaaS, technology, and marketplace environments.

22 years since 2004 · 10M+ monthly sessions owned · ~\$400K annual budget managed · Top-3 rankings, >90% of Canadian markets

EXPERIENCE

Trader Corporation (AutoTrader.ca & AutoHebdo.net)

Director, SEO — Consumer Marketing & Organic Product Lead

June 2023 – June 2026 · Mississauga, ON

Recruited to reverse a 20–25% year-over-year organic traffic decline at Canada's largest automotive marketplace. Operated at the intersection of technical product management, engineering governance, and multi-channel marketing across 5–6M indexed URLs and 10M+ monthly sessions on both the English (autotrader.ca) and French (autohebdo.net) properties.

Scope & leadership

- Embedded Product Manager for a dedicated SEO engineering squad of up to 6 (engineering lead, developers, QA), owning roadmap via Stack Rank governance and directing sprint backlogs and architecture via Jira/Confluence.
- Owned an annual SEO operating budget of approximately CAD \$400,000; terminated legacy BrightEdge contracts and provisioned seoClarity, Ahrefs, and Semrush Enterprise in their place.
- Unified organic and paid search on landing page architecture and intent-matching; directed editorial roadmap to maximize organic conversion.

Results

- Remediated a broken hreflang and canonicalization architecture across the entire marketplace — top-3 organic ranking for core non-branded categories (SUV, car, hatchback) across virtually every Canadian city, town, and province, more than 90% of the time (Q3 2025–June 2026).
- Re-engineered internal linking from a static 20–30 city model to a fully dynamic, multi-dimensional framework (brand, body type, features, price), eliminating crawl opacity and indexing tens of thousands of previously orphaned pages.
- Led two end-to-end CMS migrations — Umbraco v7/8 to Headless Umbraco v13, and Umbraco to Contently — with zero organic traffic loss.
- Brought Core Web Vitals to Google "Good" status on Homepage, VSRP, and VDP templates: LCP from 6s to <2.5s, CLS from 0.3 to 0.1.

AutoScout24 acquired Trader Corporation at the end of 2024. The Canadian SEO engineering squad was sunset and merged into European engineering during a 2025–2026 restructuring; left cleanly on June 24, 2026, concluding a successful 3-year tenure.

Self-Employed — Independent Digital Marketing Consultant

April 2007 – April 2019, and June 2023 – Present (concurrent with Trader Corporation, disclosed to employer of record)

- Grew qualified leads for an e-commerce retail client from ~20/month to 120+ (+500%) within 6–12 months by rebuilding conversion funnels and correcting checkout errors.
- Cut campaign management costs by over 34% by building automated Python data extraction to replace manual tracking with real-time dashboarding.
- Ran targeted UX/CRO A/B testing programs, improving conversion rates by up to 250%.
- Led technical SEO and compliance web development for clients in strictly regulated spaces (cannabis, vaping), maximizing visibility under federal advertising restrictions.
- Delivered technical SEO and web development for a global eSIM travel connectivity platform.

Merkle Cardinal Path

Senior Consultant, Digital Marketing / Analysis & Insights

June 2019 – July 2022 · Toronto, ON (Remote)

- Led and mentored a team of digital consultants on enterprise technical, on-page, and off-page search projects.
- Facilitated the largest enterprise SEO contract in company history — a multinational pharmaceutical engagement won on combined technical SEO and FDA/PAAB regulatory expertise.
- Designed cross-functional programs integrating organic and paid search budgets; built custom Core Web Vitals (RUM) capture, and real-time dashboards in Power BI, Tableau, and Data Studio.
- Awarded Q4 2021 Innovation & Collaboration Award for cross-functional dashboard development and sales enablement.

Klick Health

Manager, Digital Marketing / SEO

April 2018 – June 2019 · Greater Toronto Area, ON

- Built automated ETL and Python reporting processes, eliminating over \$60,000/year in redundant software licensing.
- Engineered schema markup and data-layer configurations to support pharmaceutical compliance audits against FDA, Health Canada, and PAAB regulations.
- Shaped digital strategy for a major global pharmaceutical company's blockbuster gastrointestinal brand, sustaining patient and HCP organic acquisition under strict regulatory limits.

Cardinal Path

Staff Consultant / Trainer, Digital Marketing & Analytics

December 2015 – April 2018 · Toronto, ON (Hybrid)

- Built paid and organic search strategies that grew organic traffic +150% and qualified leads +60% year-over-year.
- Led adoption of unified reporting workflows, recovering 300+ billable hours per consultant annually across a 7-client enterprise portfolio.
- Led international/bilingual SEO for a global financial services firm, resolving overlapping regional subdomain and hreflang conflicts across English, French, and German.
- Designed and delivered analytics and search optimization workshops for the Cardinal Path Training Academy.

Orkin Canada

Digital Marketing Coordinator (De Facto Digital Lead)

May 2013 – November 2015 · Mississauga, ON

- Owned the complete digital presence for a ~1,000-domain acquired subsidiary (EnviroLogic), including hosting, analytics, and bilingual platform assets.
- Managed an annual paid search budget of ~CAD \$60,000 for subsidiary properties.
- Built customer data matching and deduplication models to identify unacquired commercial targets, fueling territory-based field sales.
- Led bilingual (EN/FR) web publishing and localization workflows across national properties.

Early Career

2004 – 2013

Foundation years spanning freelance graphic design and web development, a marketing coordinator contract rebuilding a firm's web infrastructure on WordPress, and early roles in technical support and client services.

SKILLS

Technical SEO & Localization: Crawl & indexation, site architecture, canonicalization, hreflang & internationalization at enterprise scale, Core Web Vitals (LCP, CLS, INP), JS rendering optimization, schema markup, faceted navigation. Tools: Google Search Console, Screaming Frog, Lumar (DeepCrawl), Ryte, plus the certified platforms below.

Analytics & BI: GA4/UA, Adobe Analytics, Piwik/Matomo, Looker Studio, Looker, Power BI, Tableau, GTM, A/B testing & statistical CRO analysis.

Data & Scripting: Python (automation, ETL, API connectors), SQL, BigQuery, advanced Excel.

Product & Operations: Jira & Confluence sprint administration, Stack Rank executive business cases, SOW/WBS scheduling, Agile workflow governance, cross-functional leadership.

Regulated Marketing: PAAB, Health Canada, and FDA compliance marketing; CASL & GDPR compliance strategy.

Development & Platforms: HTML, CSS, PHP, JavaScript, headless architectures, Umbraco (v7/8 and Headless v13), Contently, WordPress.

Languages: Professional working proficiency in French (Humber College certificate).

Certifications: Ahrefs, SEMrush, SEO Clarity, BrightEdge (platform certifications). Humber College: Business Administration Diploma, Marketing Diploma, Business Analyst Certificate, Project Management Certificate.

TOOLS

Interactive marketing tools (UTM auditor, GTM auditor, CAC/LTV calculator, attribution modeling, disclosure checker) are live at portfolio.faysalahmed.ca/tools/ — client-side, not reproducible in a static PDF.